

Google Home Mini

If the name wasn't enough of an indicator, the Google Home Mini is the smaller version of the Google Home speaker. Functionality wise, it does just about everything its larger counterpart does, but at the \$49 price tag as compared to the Google Home's \$129 tag.

Google Home and the Home Mini can be used to play music, control smart gadgets, play videos on your chrome-cast, and do a bunch of other stuff like scheduling tasks and appointments, creating shopping lists and much more. All via voice-activated and controlled speakers.



The Home Mini is pretty small; Google compares its size to that of a donut. It's got a 4-inch diameter and curved sides, so it even looks like a donut, just without the hole in the middle.

It's covered with a textured fabric, and comes in a choice of three colours – light grey, dark grey and coral red.

The Home Mini comes as a response to Amazon's similarly priced Echo Dot which was received really well. For the time being, just from the features available to the two, it would seem that the Echo Dot and Alexa are the better choice of mini speaker.

Google Clips

One of the more interesting gadgets revealed at Made by Google was the Google Clips digital camera. But it doesn't look quite like your regular digital camera. Excluding any additional fancy features, you normally expect a sensor and lens, a display, and a snapshot button from a digital camera. Google Clips only has a camera lens, and a shutter button, but using the button is completely optional. The camera takes pictures for you. It's A.I controlled and utilises machine learning to clip interesting moments.



That's right, you simply need to place Google Clips in a place where it has a good view, turn it on, and it will capture snaps for you in bursts of 15 clips and a viewing angle of 130 degrees.

The camera can learn to recognise your family members and can even learn to ignore strangers or people it doesn't recognise. Furthermore, to address the obvious privacy issues people might have with a camera that's always watching, Google have said that the Clips only functions when you turn it on, which is clearly indicated by the blinking LEDs. It's also designed to stand out, not blend in, according to Google. The device does not sync images it captures and only saves them locally. You can only access them via your phone when you choose to and download them. Clips is priced at \$249.

YotaPhone Yota3

YotaPhone is a brand that's been trying for a while now to make dual screen phones a thing. They've already tried twice but haven't seen much success with their first two tries. But they're back with a third handset, with better hardware and a new design. You know what they say, third time's the charm.

Now when we say dual screen we're not talking something like Nintendo's DS, with one screen above the other, the Yota3 features a second display on the back, so there's a display on both faces of the phone. While the primary display is a 5.5-inch 1080p AMOLED display, the one on the back is a 5.2-inch 720p e-ink display.



The idea is that by using the secondary display for minute things like checking messages and such where we would normally unlock and use the phone's main display, you end up saving battery life. And sometimes, the use can extend beyond that. For instance, you are using a map to navigate but your phone's battery is about to expire. In this case, if the map is on the e-ink screen, then the map will be available (if not interactive) even after the phone shuts off. There can be numerous such use cases for the second display, especially with the display capabilities of e-ink increasing everyday.

The phone is powered by a Snapdragon 625 and will come with 4 gigs of RAM. There's a 12 megapixel primary camera but no selfie camera. As for the battery, it's got a 3,300mAh battery with quick charge support. USB Type-C. The phone even has a dual SIM slot, one of which can be used to extend storage via a microSD card.

The phone comes with Yota OS 3.0 which is based on Android Nougat (7.1.1) and also packs a fingerprint sensor on the front.

The Yota3 is currently available at 3,699 yuan which is roughly around ₹36,000. A bit much for those hardware specs, but none of the phones in that range sport dual screens so...